

LESSON - 6



A SPECIAL SCHOOL

Session - 1

I

PRE-READING

Teacher asks students to read the title of the lesson, see the pictures of elephants in the lesson, and answer the following questions.

- Who are the students in the special school ?
- Who will be the teachers ?
- Can you guess what the baby elephants will learn in the school ?
- Will there be punishment for the students (the baby elephants) if they do not learn ?
- Where should be the school? Should there be classrooms with walls ?

II

WHILE-READING

TEXT

SGP -1

- Read paragraphs 1 - 2 silently and answer the questions that follow.
1. Tamilnadu is a beautiful state. It has beautiful mountain ranges and valleys. Inside these mountain ranges, there are many rivers. Some of these rivers flow through the valleys. This makes these places all the more beautiful.
 2. One of the mountain ranges is Mudu Malai . At the feet of this mountain range there is a plain land. This plain range is called Karagudi. All around Karagudi, there are thick forests. A river flows across Karagudi which makes the place very very beautiful.

● **Comprehension Questions :**

1. The writer talks about three places in this part of the lesson. What are they ?
2. What makes Tamilnadu beautiful ?
3. What is Mudumalai ?
4. Where is Karagudi ?
5. What makes Karagudi beautiful ?

SGP-2

- Read paragraphs 3 - 4 silently and answer the questions that follow.

3. There is a special school in Karagudi. It is special because it is not for children. Can you guess for whom it is? It is for baby elephants. Who teaches them? The elephant trainers teach them. Like our schools, they have a timetable. They learn, play and eat according to this timetable. Baby elephants are like children, sometimes good and sometimes naughty.



4. What do baby elephants learn in this special school ? Baby elephants learn some words. For example, when the trainer says 'jo-jo', they come out of water. They learn how to salute. They also learn how to perform puja in a temple. For example, they learn how to ring the bell of the temple. They also learn to offer flowers to God.

● **Comprehension Questions :**

1. What are these paragraphs about ?
2. Why is this school special ?
3. Who are the students ?
4. Who are the teachers ?
5. Do they have a timetable like us ? How do they follow it ?
6. What do they learn ?
7. What do they learn to perform puja ?

SGP - 3

- Read paragraphs 5 - 6 silently and answer the questions that follow.

5. How do these baby elephants learn all these? Mainly through instructions, praises and punishment. Learning starts from food. Elephants are fond of banana and sugarcane. The trainer raises a piece of sugarcane over the



- head of a baby elephant. The baby elephant raises its head to eat the sugarcane. At this time the trainer says 'salam'. He does this many a time. In this way the baby elephant learns to raise its head when the trainer says 'salam' without giving sugarcane. The baby elephants are praised and given food when they act according to instructions. If they do not, they are punished.
6. The Karagudi trained elephants are in great demand. The circus people need them. In circus shows, the trained elephants salute, ride bicycle and dance to music. The temple people need them. The cinema people also need them to act in films. One such very popular film is "*Hathi Mera Sathi*".

● Comprehension Questions :

1. What is paragraph 5 about? (what they learn or how they learn)
2. Where does every lesson start from?
3. What are elephants fond of?
4. What does the baby elephant do when the trainer raises a sugar cane?
5. Then what does the trainer say?
6. What is given to the baby elephants if they follow the instructions?
7. If they don't follow.....

8. What is paragraph 6 about ?
9. Who needs Karagudi trained elephants ?
10. What do the trained elephants do in the circus ?
11. What is the name of the film in which an elephant has played an important role ?

Session - 3

III

POST-READING

1 VMDT :

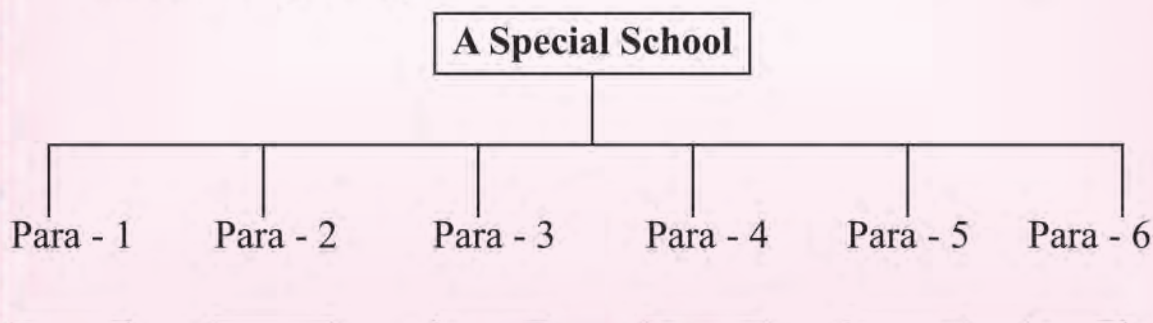
Whole Text : description of places, special school, training of baby elephants, what the trained elephants do

Part of the text : Tamilnadu, Mudumali, special school, trainers, timetable, river, banana, sugarcane, puja, circus, film.

2 Comprehension Activities :

(a) Summarizing

Teacher draws the following diagram on the blackboard and fills with information given by students.



HELP BOX

Learn how	Tamilnadu	special school	learn what
Elephants in demand	Mudu Malai	Karagudi	

(b) MCQs : Choose the correct options and fill in the blanks.

1. The special school at Karagudi is for _____.
(A) tigers
(B) elephants
(C) lions
(D) monkeys
2. Trainers teach the elephants using _____.
(A) mango
(B) orange
(C) sugarcane
(D) sweets
3. When the trainer says _____, the elephants come out of water.
(A) salam
(B) ho- ho
(C) jo-jo
(D) bho-bho
4. Trained elephants cannot _____.
(A) climb trees
(B) pull huge logs of wood
(C) work in circus
(D) act in films

3 Listening :

Teacher will read aloud the last paragraph of the text slowly. Students listen and fill in the blanks.

The Karagudi trained _____ are in great demand. The _____ people need them. In _____ shows, the trained elephants _____, ride _____ and dance to _____. The cinema _____ need them to act in _____.

Session - 5

4 Speaking :

(a) Practise the following dialogues.

Steps:

- Teacher reads aloud the dialogues, students listen.
- Teacher reads aloud one sentence , students repeat after him/her.
- Role-play.

(Let the students see the text and read aloud the dialogue)

- Teacher vs. students
- Students vs. students
- Student vs. student

Ramesh : I'm Rajesh . I'm from Odisha .

Vasudevan : I'm Vasudevan . I'm from Tamilnadu .

Ramesh : Where in Tamilanadu ?

Vasudevan : Karagudi .

Ramesh : O karagudi ! The name sounds popular.

Vassudevan : O yes. It's famous for the Elephant School.

Ramesh : Have you ever visited the school?

Vasudevan : Many a time!

Ramesh : What do the elephants learn ?

Vasudevan : They learn to salute , perform puja , ride bicycles and many more.

Ramesh : Do they get reward for good work?

Vasudevan : Yes, when they do something well , they are given sweets, sugarcane or bananas.

Ramesh : And if they fail to do something well?

Vasudevan : In that case, they get no reward. That's the punishment.

Ramesh : That is wonderful !

Vasudevan : Sorry . My mother is calling me . Bye .

Ramesh : Thanks! Bye!

- (b) In English there are some words with 'ee', 'ea', or 'oo','ie' in their spelling. We take long time to speak them out. Given below are some such words. Your teacher will say these words one after another. Repeat after him/her. Then add some more words to the list.

ee

green

need

feet

oo

fool

food

school

ea

teacher

eat

seat

ie

piece

belief

relief

Session - 6

5 Vocabulary :

- (a) Read paragraph -1 of the lesson and watch the following words. There is another word inside in each of them. The words are underlined.

State

Forest

Mountain

Clear

Now read paragraph - 3 and find words inside words in the list below.

teach = tea, each

because = _____

children = _____

there = _____

training = _____

understand = _____

sugarcane = _____

Session - 7

- (b) Make word chain . Use the last letter of a word as the first letter of the next word, for example:-

SUGARCANE > EAT > TIMETABLE > ELEPHANT > TRAINING
> GOOD

Add more words to complete the chain of three lines.

- (c) Some words from your lesson are described below. Figures in brackets show paragraph number in the text. Find the words and write them in the blanks.

Students go there for the study. (3) -

Teacher of elephants.(3) -

An elephant does it by raising its trunk.(5) -

A place of worship. (4) -

A big animal with a trunk (4) -

Children are sometimes good and sometimes like this.(3) -

A large area covered with trees. (1) -

Work schedule (3) -

A tall plant with sweet stem.(5) -

Session - 8

6 Usage:

Look at the underlined parts in the sentences.

- They learn how to salute.
- They learn how to perform puja in temple.

These sentences can be written as:

- They learn how they should salute.
- They also know how they should perform puja in temple.

“How to” is written as “how + the doer + should”

Rewrite the following sentences using “how to” in place of ' how.....should'. One is done for you.

- (i) Elephants are taught how they should salute.

Ans - Elephants are taught how to salute.

- (ii) A trained elephant knows how he should act in films.
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- (iii) A pilot is trained how he should fly an aeroplane.
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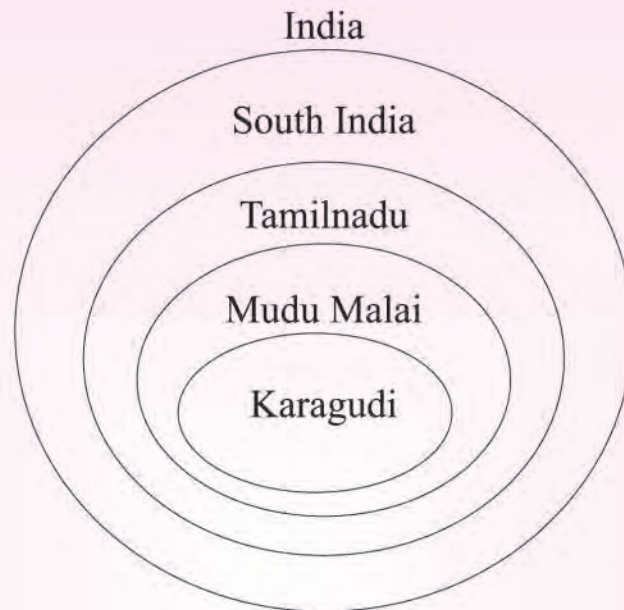
- (iv) A fisherman knows how he should fish in a deep river.
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- (v) A doctor has learnt how he should treat serious patients.
-

- (vi) Baby elephants are taught how they should play tricks in circus.
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7 Writing:

- (a) See the diagram and do the following activities.



- (i) Karagudi is in Mudumalai .
- (ii) Mudumalai is _____.
- (iii) _____.
- (iv) _____.

Now write beginning with India.

- (i) Inside India is South India.
- (ii) _____.
- (iii) _____.
- (iv) _____.
- (b) Answer the following questions in one sentence each. (Half of the answer you get from the question itself and half from the text.)

(i) Why is the school called a special school ?

(ii) Who are the students there ?

(iii) Who teaches there ?

(iv) Where is the school ?

(v) Where is Karagudi ?

(vi) How do elephants salute ?

Elephants _____ by raising _____

(vii) How do elephants perform pooja ?

(viii) What work do elephants learn to do ?

(ix) What do elephants learn to do for circus ?

Session -10

(c) Answer the following questions.

(I) Write 5 sentences about the school. (This answer can be done by putting together the answers of questions 1-5.)

(ii) What do elephants learn in special school ?

(iii) Write how the baby elephants learn at the special schol. (Part - 5)

8 Mental Talk :

Elephants do a lot of job for man. But they suffer a lot for us.

9 Let Us Think :

Animals are born free. But everywhere they are in chains. Man is cruel to them. How ?

FOLLOW-UP LESSON

MAHAGIRI- THE KIND ELEPHANT

Session - 1

I

PRE-READING

- Teacher will plan the activity.

II

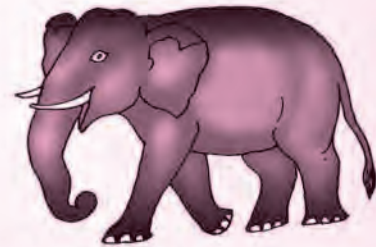
WHILE-READING

TEXT

SGP - 1

- Read paragraph - 1 silently and answer the questions that follow.

1. Mahagiri was a big elephant. He was trained at a special school. He was bought by a merchant. The merchant made a lot of money by putting Mahagiri to work. The elephant was often sent to the forest to carry heavy logs of wood. Sometimes, he carried people from one place to another. Once, he even carried a bridegroom to the bride's house! At times he was sent to a famous temple in a village nearby to lead the festival procession.



1. Who is this paragraph about ?
2. Where was Mahagiri trained ?
3. Who bought it ?
4. How did the merchant make a lot of money ?

5. Mahagiri did four kinds of work. They are ;

- (i) _____
- (ii) _____
- (iii) _____
- (iv) _____

SGP-2

- Read paragraph 2 silently and answer the questions that follow.

2. Once the people of the village wanted to celebrate their temple festival. The festival could not start till the temple flag was put up. The temple had the flag, but no flag pole. So the villagers went to the forest and made a fine flagpole out of a tall tree. The flagpole was too heavy for the villagers to carry. And so Mahagiri brought it to the temple. The villagers also wanted the elephant's help to fix the flagpole in the ground. They had already dug a hole in front of the temple.



- **Comprehension Questions**

- 1. What are these paragraphs about?
- 2. What did the villagers want to do?
- 3. What did they have but what did not.....?
- 4. Who carried the flag pole ?
- 5. What did they want Mahagiri to do next?

Session - 2

SGP - 3

- Read paragraphs 3 - 4 silently and answer the questions that follow.
- 3. Now, Mahagiri carried the flagpole up to the hole. But suddenly he stopped and turned back. The mahout, who was sitting on him, ordered him to put the flagpole in the hole, but Mahagiri would not move. The mahout shouted and screamed at him but still he did not move. The villagers were angry and they shouted at the mahout. Mahagiri could not stand the noise any longer. He threw away the flagpole. And the mahout was also thrown off. The people became so frightened that they ran away for their lives.
- 4. Mahagiri was now alone. He moved to the hole and went down on his forelegs. He put his long trunk into the hole and gently picked up a kitten! The little cat had been hiding in the hole. The people had been watching all this. They now knew why the elephant had not obeyed the mahout's orders. He did not like to kill the kitten. Mahagiri then placed the flagpole into the hole and held it straight with his trunk. Everyone at the temple gave sweets and fruits to the elephant. From that day Mahagiri became the villagers' favourite elephant and the children's best friend.

(The teacher will try to frame questions. Some are done.)

1. Did Mahagiri fix the pole?
2. Why were the villagers angry?
3. What did they do?
4. What did Mahagiri bring out?
5. What did the villagers realize?
6. What did they give to Mahagiri?

Session - 3

III

POST-READING

1 Writing :

- (a) Write answers to the following questions.
 - (i) Who is Mahagiri ?

(ii) Who carried the flagpole for the villagers ?

(iii) Why did Mahagiri not fix the pole first time ?

because there was a _____

(iv) How did Mahagiri pick up the kitten?

He went _____,

(ii) One villager narrates the incident to a man from another village. Read and fill in the gaps.

To celebrate our festival , we wanted to fix the _____. We wanted Mahagiri to do this. But he did not _____.

The mahout forced him to do. But he _____.

The villagers were angry. They shouted at _____.

Mahagiri was _____. He threw off the _____

_____ the mahout. He also _____ the

mahout. They all ran away out of fear. Do you know what

_____ did next ? He pulled out a _____ from the

_____. What a kind elephant !

WORD NOTE

(The words / phrases have been defined mostly on contextual meanings.)

all the more - even more, ଅଧିକତର

bridegroom - man on his wedding day, ବର ବା ବରପାତ୍ର

celebrate - to mark an event with festivities, ଉତ୍ସବ ପାଳନ କରିବା

flag pole - a pole with flag, ପତାକା ଦଣ୍ଡ

frightened - afraid of, ଭୟିତ, ଭୟଭୀତ ହେବା

instructions - orders asking to do something ନିର୍ଦ୍ଦେଶ

mahout - the person who drives and trains elephants ମାହୁତ

mountain ranges - continuous chain of mountains ପର୍ବତମାଳା

naughty - behaving badly, childish naughty behaviour ଦୁଷ୍ଟ, ଚଗଳା

obeyed - worked as per instructions, ନିର୍ଦ୍ଦେଶ ମୁତାବକ କାମ କରୁଥିଲେ

perform - do, କାର୍ଯ୍ୟ କରିବା

praises - saying good things about somebody ପ୍ରଶଂସା

shouted and screamed - loud cry (here) instructing the elephant to do - ଘାଟି କରୁଥିଲେ, ଚିଲେଇଥିଲେ

sugarcane - sugar plant, ଆଖୁ

valley - low area in between hills, ଉପତ୍ୟକା